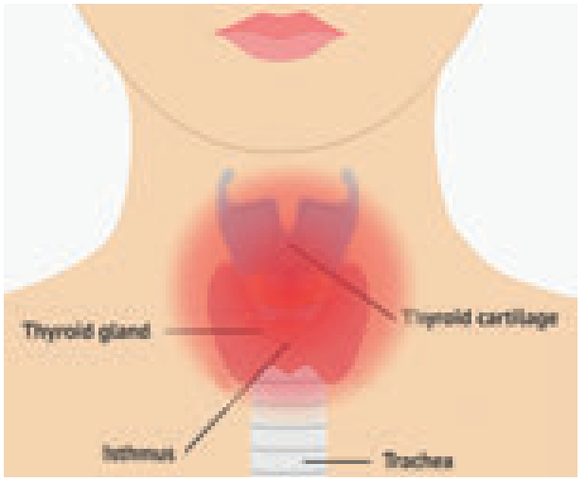


Figure 20.3 Adam's apple

20.2.2 Secondary Sex Characteristics of Girls

Girls show the following secondary sex characteristics at the time of puberty.

a. Hips

Due to the enlargement of the pelvic bone and the development of subcutaneous fat, the hip becomes wider and rounder.

b. Breast

After the enlargement of hips, the breasts begin to develop during this time.

c. Hair

Pubic hair appears followed by axillary and body hair on the limbs.

d. Muscles

Increase in muscles takes place which gives shape to shoulders, arms and legs.

e. Voice

Voice becomes shrill and voice breaks are rare among girls.

f. Skin

The skin becomes coarser and the pores enlarge as in the case of boys.

g. Gland

Oil producing glands become active causing acne on the face.

DO YOU KNOW?

The secretions of sweat and sebaceous or subcutaneous glands (Oil glands) are very active during adolescence. Many adolescent boys and girls get pimples on face because of increased activity of these glands in the skin. Owing to extra secretions sometimes a distinctive odour is also produced from the bodies.

Table 20.1 Secondary sex characteristics in boys and girls.

Girls	Boys
Height and weight increase.	Height and weight increase.
Fatty and subcutaneous tissues develop.	Muscles develop.
Hip broadens.	Shoulder broadens.
Hair grows in arm pits and pubic area.	Hair grows in the arm pits and pubic area, and facial hair also appears.
Voice becomes shrill.	Voice break takes place due to lengthening of vocal cord and enlarging of larynx.
Breast develops.	Size of the penis increases.

Activity 2

Answer the following questions.

- Has your voice changed?
- Are there pimples or acne on your face?
- Do you feel that some changes have taken place in your body?

These changes are normal in your development. Discuss with your teacher or counsellor in your school and clarify your doubts.

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